

Windows Server Post-Installation Checklist

Recommended Tasks to Consider After Fresh Installation

Consider these recommended tasks to help ensure your Windows Server is properly configured and ready for use

Recommendation Levels

 **Highly Recommended**

 **Recommended**

 **Consider If Applicable**



Initial System Configuration



Consider Changing Computer Name

Rename from generic name to meaningful server name following your naming convention



Consider Setting Correct Time Zone

Configure appropriate time zone for server location and sync with time servers



Consider Activating Windows License

Enter product key and activate Windows Server license as needed



Review Network Settings

Consider setting static IP address, subnet mask, gateway, and DNS servers as appropriate



Join Domain (if applicable)

Join server to Active Directory domain or configure as domain controller



Configure Power Settings

Set power plan to "High Performance" and disable sleep/hibernation



Security Configuration



Consider Changing Administrator Password

Set strong, unique password for built-in Administrator account



Enable Windows Firewall

Ensure Windows Defender Firewall is enabled for all profiles



Configure User Account Control



Enable Windows Defender

Set appropriate UAC level and create non-admin user accounts

Configure Windows Defender Antivirus and real-time protection



Configure Remote Desktop

Enable RDP with Network Level Authentication if remote access needed



Configure Account Lockout Policy

Set account lockout threshold and duration for failed login attempts



Windows Updates & Drivers



Review Windows Updates

Consider downloading and installing critical and important Windows updates



Install Hardware Drivers

Update network, storage, and other hardware drivers to latest versions



Configure Windows Update Settings

Set automatic update schedule and configure WSUS if applicable



Create System Restore Point

Create initial restore point after completing basic configuration



Server Roles & Features



Install Required Server Roles

Add necessary roles like IIS, DNS, DHCP, File Services, etc.



Configure Server Manager

Set up Server Manager dashboard and configure server groups



Install Windows Admin Center

Install modern web-based management interface



Configure PowerShell Execution Policy

Set appropriate PowerShell execution policy for scripts



Monitoring & Logging



Configure Event Log Settings

Set appropriate event log sizes and retention policies



Enable Performance Monitoring

Configure Performance Monitor counters and data collection



Configure SNMP (if needed)



Set Up Disk Space Monitoring

Install and configure SNMP service for network monitoring

Configure alerts for low disk space conditions

Backup & Recovery



Consider Backup Strategy

Evaluate setting up Windows Server Backup or third-party backup solution with regular schedule



Test Backup and Restore

Perform test backup and verify restore process works correctly



Document Recovery Procedures

Create documentation for disaster recovery procedures



Documentation & Final Steps



Document Server Configuration

Record IP addresses, roles, passwords, and configuration settings



Label Physical Server

Apply physical labels with server name and basic information



Restart and Verify

Perform final restart and verify all services start correctly



Update Asset Inventory

Add server to IT asset management system or inventory

Disclaimer: These are general recommendations for consideration. For production environments, always consult with your organization's policies, security requirements, and vendor documentation before making configuration changes.

Note: This checklist covers common post-installation considerations. Additional configuration may be required based on specific server roles and organizational requirements.